

CAN T20 WORLD CUP CRACK THE AMERICAN DREAM?

The United States will host a cricket World Cup **for the first time in its history** as the game seeks to extend its reach beyond its traditional borders.

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The early indicator of a readily available market came in 2015 when the Cricket All-Star Series was held in the United States of America. The exhibition T20 series, which featured two teams led by retired legends

Sachin Tendulkar and Shane Warne, was held in three cities: New York City, Houston, and Los Angeles. The games were held in a baseball stadium, which was altered with drop-in pitches.

Despite the makeshift arrangements, crowds poured in. Enthusiasm was high, especially among the Indian diaspora. In the second outing held in Houston,

around 26,000 fans thronged Minute Maid Park. **The chance to see the likes of Tendulkar, Warne, Ricky Ponting, Brian Lara, Kumar Sangakkara, and Jacques Kallis in the flesh was simply too tempting to pass on.** The third match in Los Angeles brought fans from all over California State, home to a sizeable number of cricket-crazy Indians.

For the players, the novelty was